

# AYUSH SHUKLA

MPA/ID CLASS OF 2025

HARVARD KENNEDY SCHOOL

## CONTACT DETAILS

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5 years of professional experience across impact investing, public sector and entrepreneurship in South and Southeast Asia. Interested in development finance, philanthropy and facilitating cross-border collaborations in the US-India corridor. With a network of entrepreneurs, non-profits, government officials, investors and entrepreneur support organizations, now seeking opportunities to drive development programs and commercial partnerships between India and the world.

## EDUCATION

### Harvard University, John F. Kennedy School of Government

Master in Public Administration in International Development

2025

- **Co-Chair, India Conference at Harvard 2025:** Led a team of 100+ graduate students to organize the annual conference with 1000+ attendees with senior leaders from India and the world.
- **Thesis Honorable Mention Award:** Leveraging and Scaling Diaspora Philanthropy for India's Development.
- **Vice President, Impact Investing Club:** Managed programs at Harvard Kennedy School to assist students in pursuing careers in impact investing and development finance; led student treks to meet firms.
- **Course Assistant** for 'Managing the Private Delivery of Public Value' & 'Politics and Policies: The Impact of Data and AI', 'Sports Economics', and 'Math Camp' for the incoming MPA/ID class.
- **Teaching Fellow** for GOV1737 - Course on Randomized Controlled Trials at the Harvard College.
- **Coursework:** Courses in Advanced Macroeconomics and Microeconomics, Advanced Quantitative Methods, Development Economics, Growth Strategy, Finance, Entrepreneurship Ecosystems.

### K.J. Somaiya College of Engineering, Vidyavihar

Electronics Engineering

2018

- Founding Member, Debate Society
- Co-founder & Lead Organizer, TEDxSomaiyaVidyavihar
- Literary Secretary, Students' Council

### Delhi Public School

2014

- Head Boy, Students' Council of the academic body from grades 1-12; Captain, Hockey Team

## WORK EXPERIENCE

### Harvard Business School Foundry

Business Development | July 2025 - Present

- Creating partnerships with institutions at the national and subnational levels in India to facilitate product launch in India and other emerging markets.

### Harvard University

Teaching Fellow | Aug 2025\* onwards

- Teaching undergraduate classes on Personal Finance (ECON70) with Prof. John Campbell.

### Asian Venture Philanthropy Network

Sustainable Finance Associate | June 2024 - Aug 2024

- Building and executing the market entry strategy for AVPN's blended finance practice and portfolio.
- Liaised with multinational organizations like the World Bank, IFC, Development Finance Corporation, Millennium Challenge Corporation, USAID to create an AVPN-managed blended finance funding facility.

## **Village Capital**

**Senior Programs Associate, South Asia | Dec 2022 - Aug 2023**

**Programs Associate, South Asia | Nov 2020 - Dec 2022**

- Led investments - due diligence, built thesis, sourced companies in financial inclusion sector in South Asia.
- Managed 5 accelerator programs for 50+ startups - sourcing and evaluation in South/Southeast Asia.
- Built a network of 150+ investors and industry experts to support startups, catalyze venture funding.
- Managing external communication and point of contact for entrepreneurs in South/Southeast Asia region.
- Researched and drafted reports/studies on the domestic and international migrant trends within Asia.
- Built partnerships for female-led accelerator programs in Afghanistan, Nepal, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka.
- Drafted an internal DEI-focused regional action plan for engagement with entrepreneurs.

## **Maharashtra State Innovation Society, Government of Maharashtra**

**Chief Minister's Fellow (Selected in a cohort of 45 from >8,000 applicants) | Sep 2019 - Aug 2020**

- Managed the Operations and Outreach efforts for Maharashtra Startup Week 2020.
- Worked on and provided inputs on draft Maharashtra State Startup Policy 2020.
- Designed a monitoring and review mechanism for 16 technology business incubators across Maharashtra.
- Led partnership between the Vocational Education Department and Udhyam Foundation to include entrepreneurial thinking in the curriculum, benefiting close to 140K students every year.
- Devised implementation framework for the Intellectual Property Rights Support Scheme for startups.

## **COVID-19 Relief Efforts (As a Chief Minister's Fellow)**

- Facilitated donations of ~ USD 4M to government hospitals across state for COVID relief efforts, as liaison with SBI Foundation, Capgemini, HT Parekh, CII, ESSAR, ATE Chandra Foundation, among others.
- Streamlined daily patient data collection processes with MCGM War Room for 120 COVID facilities across Mumbai. Led adoption of tech platforms - Bed & Supplies Management App across all COVID facilities.
- Prepared recommendation reports for COVID relief measures undertaken in NMMC, capacity augmentation in govt hospitals, ambulance service improvement, patient triaging.
- Set up social media teams for the Medical Education and Drugs Department, and Cyber Cell for countering misinformation around COVID with more than 2 million average impressions per post.
- Collated and created daily dashboard reports for migrant transfers across Maharashtra.

## **riidl (Research Innovation Incubation Design Labs)**

**Program Manager, Startup Incubator | Aug 2018 - July 2019**

- Designed and launched Startup School India course - a cohort-based program for aspiring entrepreneurs.
- Planned & executed an immersion trek to innovation and incubation centers in China.
- Created innovation pipelines through Maker Mela, and Project-Based Learning for innovators.
- Conducted workshops and co-created joint programs with campus institutes and faculty members to build Design Thinking capacity in the university, through curriculum changes and teaching approaches.

## **VOLUNTEERING**

**Investment Committee Member, Nidhi Prayas, riidl (Jan 2022 - Present)**

- Part of a 7-membered investment committee to deploy seed capital in early-stage companies.

**Fellow & Pro-bono advisor, Tinker Qubits (earlier Gyanada Foundation) (Aug 2018 - Present)**

- Advising on partnerships, business development, financial, and fundraising strategies for the NGO.
- Taught math concepts, visual programming to middle school students from disadvantaged backgrounds.

**Co-Founder, Green Teens**

- Formed a team of 8 teenagers that organized plantations & awareness drives, nature walks, conservation marches, and campaigns for reducing local plastic usage.